

like *Kumkum Bhagya* and *Pavitra Rishta*, ran for over 1,000 episodes, while *Yeh Rish-ta Kya Kehlata Hai* has been on air for more than 10 years now, minting money for both the producer and TV network. “Now 60-70 per cent of Hindi shows don’t make it past the one-year mark, and many get shut down in four to five months,” says Shahi, Founder of Director’s Kut Productions.

That sucks out the business’s profitability, as shows are planned with 260 episodes a year. In that format, shows take about 100 episodes to break even and start making money around the 160-mark. “But if my show runs only for 160 episodes, I don’t make any money. If it shuts in 80 episodes, I lose money,” adds Tewari. Shahi says he spends a lot of time explaining to actors, directors, and technicians that budgets are not going up even if the show

is successful. In fact, per-episode budgets have declined 25-30 per cent over the past year across both languages, says Shahi.

SOUTHERN ACCENT

In the South, where India’s second- and third-most thriving TV soap industries of Tamil and Telugu are housed, the scenario is slightly different. Shows continue to garner double-digit primetime TRPs. “The southern markets (Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, Karnataka, and Kerala) have a higher TV penetration of around 95 per cent compared to states such as Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Madhya Pradesh, where it is only about 42 per cent,” says media and entertainment industry expert Rajib Basu, who is Partner at professional services firm PwC. Besides, he adds, channels such as Star Plus, Colors and Zee TV have a higher share in the urban areas of Hindi-speaking markets, while the rural space has a higher penetration of free-to-air channels like Dangal, Star Utsav and Goldmines.

Plus, southern audiences simply love to watch more television. Prime time in the south is between 6 pm and 11 pm, while it starts at 7.30 pm in the Hindi belt and ends at 11 pm, says Jai

ND NOW



A similar trend in Tamil TV serials, too, though in Telugu the TRP of the top show has remained almost the same

SEPTEMBER 2023

HINDI

Show	TRP (U+R)	TRP (Urban)	Channel
<i>Anupamaa</i>	1.78	3.02	Star Plus
<i>Teri Meri Dooriyan</i>	1.28	1.97	Star Plus
<i>Yeh Hai Chahatein</i>	1.08	1.93	Star Plus
<i>Pandya Store</i>	1.25	1.89	Star Plus
<i>Imlie</i>	1.35	1.87	Star Plus

U: URBAN; R: RURAL

SOURCE: BARC DATA (WEEK 35: AUG 26 TO SEPT 1)

NOTE: HINDI SHOWS SORTED BY URBAN SCORE

TAMIL

Show	TRP (U+R)	Channel
<i>Kayal</i>	12.22	Sun TV
<i>Ethirneechal</i>	11.61	Sun TV
<i>Sundari</i>	11.61	Sun TV
<i>Vanathai Pola</i>	10.06	Sun TV
<i>Iniya</i>	9.77	Sun TV

SOURCE: BARC DATA (WEEK 35: AUG 26 TO SEPT 1), VALUES AVERAGE OF TN/PUDUCHERRY (U+R)

TOP-RATED SHOWS IN

TELUGU: *Brahma Mudi*, Star Maa, 15.34

MARATHI: *Tharala Tar Mag*, Star Pravaah, 8.97

BENGALI: *Anurager Chhowa*, Star Jalsha, 10.92